

DAILY PROGRESS / PREPARED FOR RICK

A place to work. A room worth building.

The website is now organized around Rick's artwork, feedback and daily progress. The drawing work is moving back to a measured bare room, so each later piece can be improved without disturbing the rest.

1,641

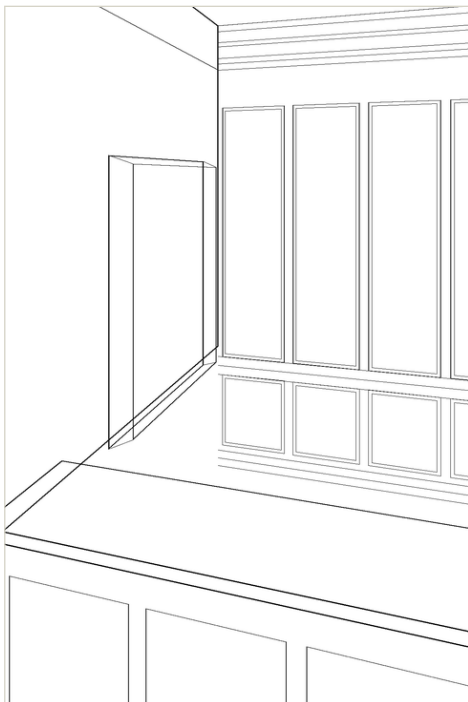
images brought together

13

room studies to explore

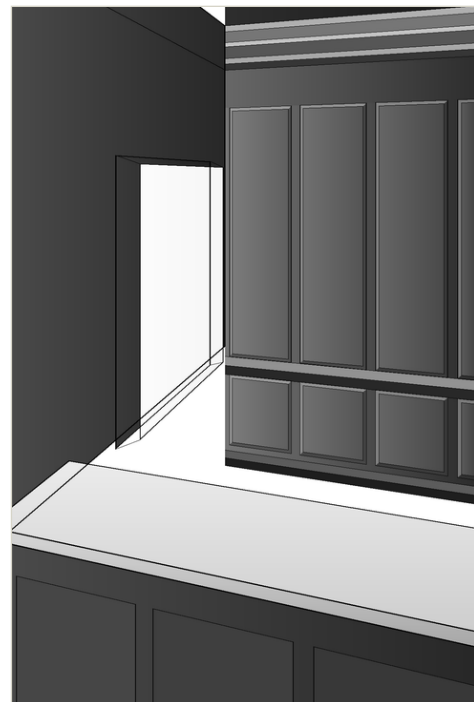
First

the wall, window and bar



PLANNING THE ROOM

The latest planning drawings included in this report. The proportions and lighting are still being refined.



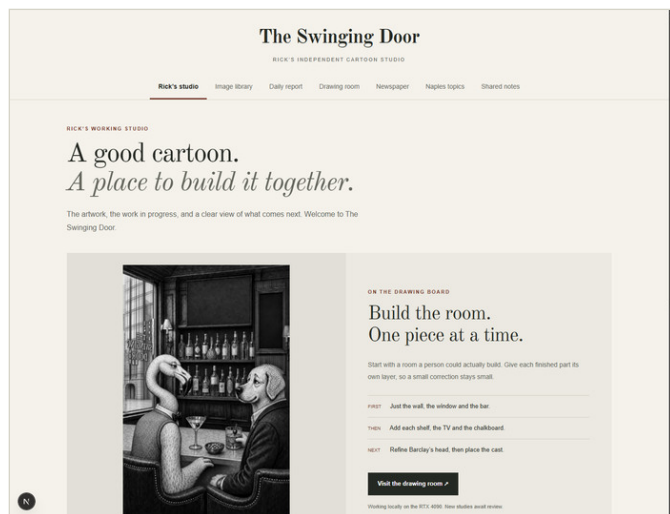
PLANNING THE LIGHT AND SHADE

The direction: give Rick a clear place to see the work and shape what comes next. Perfect the room first, add the pieces carefully, then develop a dependable rhythm of topical cartoons.

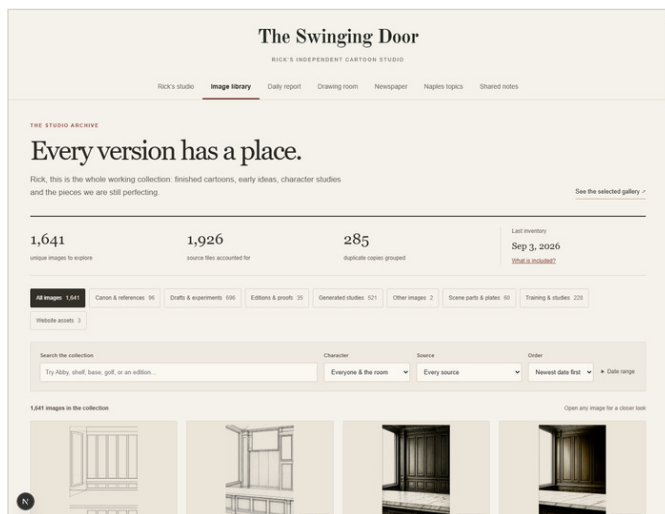
THE WEBSITE

Rick's working studio

The redesigned website brings the project together: earlier artwork, new studies, feedback and a clear picture of the next steps. These pictures show the working preview.



Home: Rick's branding and the current drawing plan.



Library: search, cast filters, dates and image history.

The archive is easier to use

1,641 drawings, studies and earlier versions are gathered in one place. Duplicate copies are grouped, and the collection can be searched by character, type of work and date.

Each character has a place

Drew, Barclay and Abby have their own image groups. Scenes with more than one character can appear in each relevant group, making references easier to find.

A calmer, clearer design

The site is presented as Rick's studio. The home page leads directly to artwork, progress reports, the drawing room, newspaper ideas and shared notes.

A clear way to catch up

Progress updates bring the pictures and explanations together: what improved, what still needs feedback, and what comes next.

Notes stay with the conversation

Private shared notes can include an image, a topic and the writer's name. A note can be attached directly to the picture being discussed.

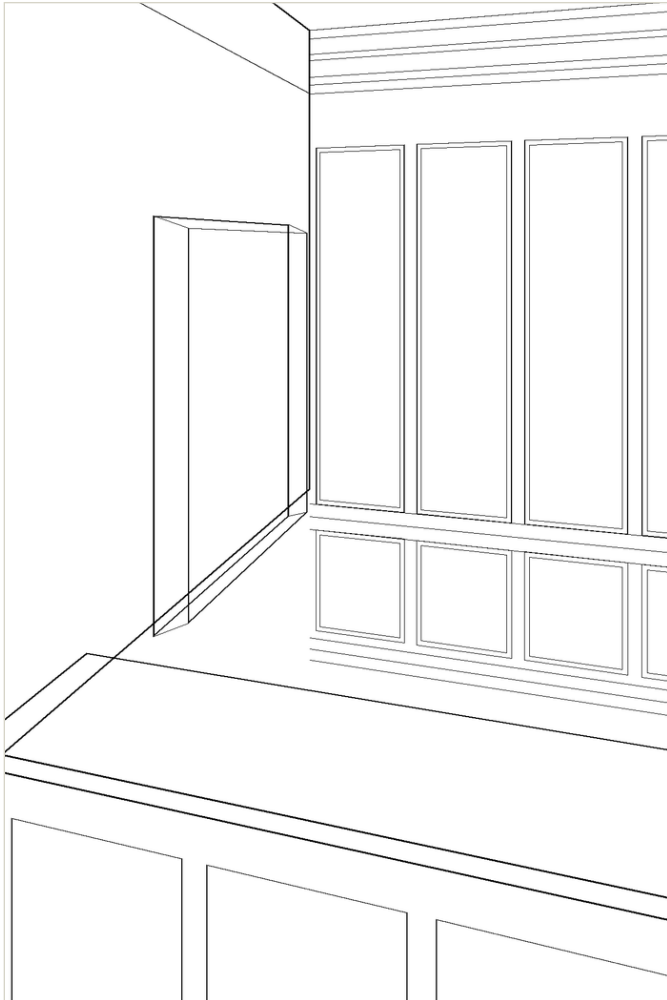
Ready for a closer look

The redesigned studio is available to review. Its usual website address still shows the earlier version. The new design can be refined before it becomes the main site.

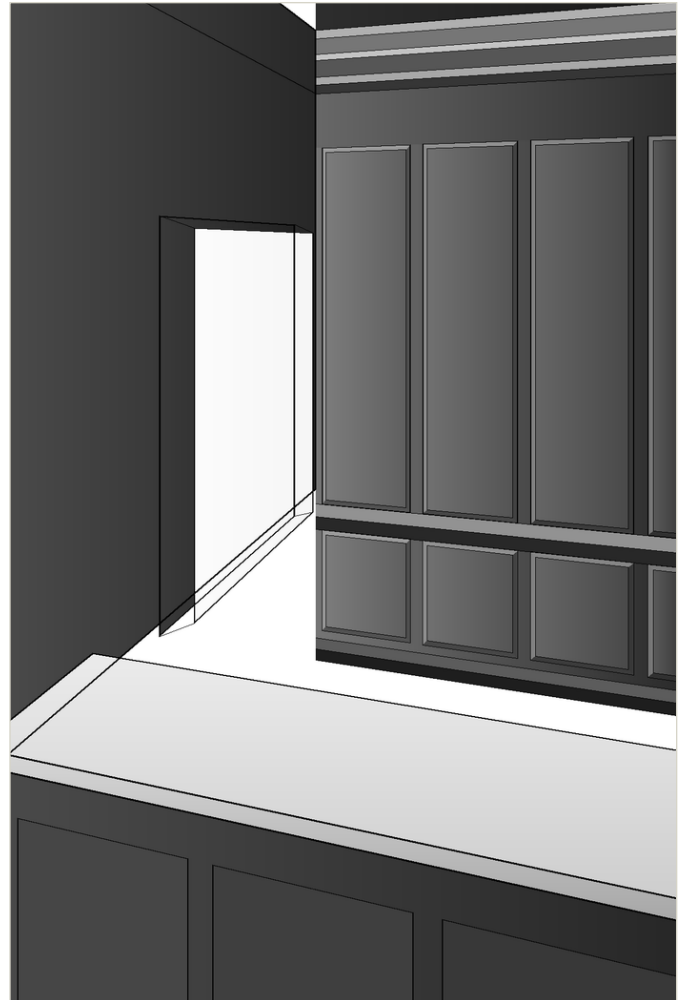
THE ROOM / CURRENT DIRECTION

Start with a room a person could build.

The first drawing needs only the wall, window and bar. Shelves, television, chalkboard, street view and characters will follow once the room itself feels right.

**01 MEASURED CONSTRUCTION**

A fixed viewpoint and real measurements guide the wall panels, window opening and counter. The angled view stays while the room's proportions are adjusted.

**02 SHARED LIGHTING PLAN**

A shared plan for light and shade helps every later piece belong in the same room. Each drawing still needs a close look for believable shadows and consistent pen strokes.

Still being refined: these planning drawings show the newer room arrangement. The finished-looking studies on the next page explore an earlier version of the room.

PROGRESS IN THE DRAWING

What the room studies taught us.

Earlier studies helped clarify the woodwork, marble and lighting. They show useful progress while also revealing details that need another pass.

**Strip back the old scene**

An early attempt to remove furnishings and expose the room.

**Make the woodwork believable**

Wood grain follows each board, with clearer panels and supporting rails.

**Bring in light and shade**

A promising study of the finishes, with counter and window details still to resolve.

WHAT STILL REQUIRES AN ARTIST'S EYE

Construction

Counter depth and support, believable window thickness, clean wall junctions and consistent panel joints.

Mark-making

Wood grain must follow the boards. Hatching, edge weight and fur texture must hold together at newspaper size.

Image cleanup

The earlier rendered candidate has faint guide lines in the window. Those are defects to remove before approval.

THE DRAWING APPROACH

Build the picture in replaceable parts.

The piece-by-piece approach is being tested. The aim is to improve one shelf, window or character without accidentally changing the rest of the drawing.



An earlier experiment with the furnished room shows how the pieces can work together. The room and characters still need refinement.

1. Get the bare room right

Set the angle, proportions, wall, window and counter. This becomes the dependable starting point.

2. Draw each piece to fit

Build each shelf and fixture against the same room, with matching perspective, lighting and style.

3. Look closely, then put it together

Check the edges and pen strokes. If one piece needs another pass, change that piece while protecting the rest.

4. Bring in the cast and the joke

Place the characters once the room works. Then add a short, carefully set caption that is easy to read.

STILL TO BUILD AND REFINE

Room: upper shelf, lower shelf, wall corner, TV and chalkboard.

Street: modern New York, a hot-dog stand and indistinct people.

Cast: Barclay's head and ear, then an Abby whose appearance feels right.

Drawing: use the studio's own computer and RTX 4090, moving away from Replicate.

THE NEWSPAPER

Drew and Barclay take the page.

The newspaper now features an existing Drew-and-Barclay cartoon with its matching caption. This lets Rick see how the work might read beside a real column of type.

THE NAPLES EDITION

OPINION / MARKETS / EVERYDAY LIFE

The Swinging Door

Thursday, September 3, 2026

OPINION & PERSPECTIVE

PAGE 1

THE EDITORIAL PAGE

Where the headlines meet the household.

The numbers make the news. What we make of them is another story.

The price of paying attention

From the editor's desk

A financial headline can travel halfway around the world before it reaches the kitchen table. By then, it has acquired a different unit of measurement: a monthly payment, an insurance renewal or the price on a familiar menu.

That is where this page begins. The economy is more than a chart on a screen. It is also the small calculation before a decision and the conversation that follows it.

In Naples, there is room for a financial cartoon that recognizes those conversations without turning every reader into an analyst. A good drawing needs an observation. A good caption leaves something for the reader to discover.

A smaller stage

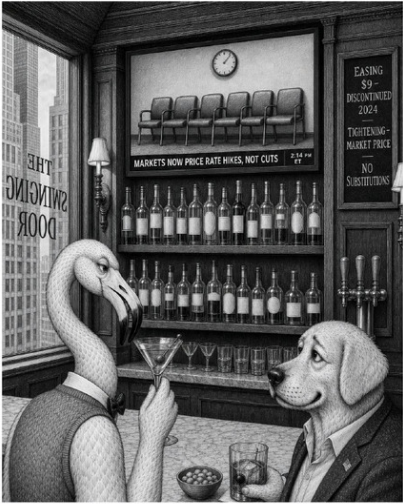
The Swinging Door gives that conversation a room of its own. Drew supplies the dry observation. Barclay brings the bill back to human scale. Abby has heard enough of both to know when the discussion is over.

The bar is a setting for the joke, not its subject. The subject is the distance between an announcement and the ordinary day it eventually reaches.

There is no need to shout across that distance. Sometimes the quietest sentence carries furthest.

The Swinging Door

AN EDITORIAL CARTOON



Barclay: "I don't mind a rate hike. I'd just like two years of waiting for a cut counted as time served."

THE SWINGING DOOR / ARCHIVE ARTWORK A01

*"The conversation is local.
The absurdity travels."*

AROUND THE TABLE

A number is only the beginning

A house can have a market value, an assessed value and a taxable value. An insurance quote can look simple until the coverage is compared. A familiar asking price can imply an unfamiliar payment.

Those distinctions are worth explaining. They are also fertile ground for a cartoon, provided the joke rests on the difference itself and not on somebody's misfortune.

What earns a place here

A specific observation. A clear visual scene. Characters with different ways of seeing the same piece of news. A line short enough to read once and interesting enough to read again.

The point is recognition: that slight pause when a reader realizes the person at the next stool has been doing the same arithmetic.

Three seats. One conversation.

Drew
The measured observer.

Barclay
The number on the receipt.

Abby
The last word, when needed.

What changed

The web newspaper and downloadable 11 x 17 PDF now use a Drew-and-Barclay-only cartoon. The image, credit and caption match.

Getting Abby right

The unwanted version of Abby has been removed. She will return to the newspaper only when her appearance is right.

What this proves

The cartoon can be judged in an editorial page: column width, caption size, surrounding text and grayscale balance.

Still a layout proof

This is not an issued newspaper. Final publication needs the newspaper's actual column width, image resolution and grayscale specifications.

Barclay: "I don't mind a rate hike. I'd just like two years of waiting for a cut counted as time served."

PROGRESS & DIRECTION / THE SWINGING DOOR

06 / 09

NAPLES / EDITORIAL DIRECTION

Research first. Daily cartoons later.

The long-term aim is a local financial cartoon informed by search interest and actual audience response. Today's work establishes a research desk, not an automatic publishing system.

GOOGLE TRENDS: OBSERVED SEPTEMBER 3

The research used the Ft. Myers-Naples metro, Web Search, all categories, and the past 90 days. Naples-city results were insufficient. These are relative growth labels, not search-volume totals or proof of readership. Google labels growth above 5,000% "Breakout."

PROPERTY TAX

"property tax exemption florida"

+80%

A possible joke about the difference between a house's market, assessed and taxable values.

HOME INSURANCE

"home insurance quotes florida"

+50%

A possible joke about what a quote appears to promise and what the actual coverage contains.

MORTGAGE RATES

"what are the current mortgage rates"

Breakout

A possible joke about waiting for lower rates while an ordinary purchase cannot wait forever.

LEARNING WHAT READERS RESPOND TO

Website readership information still needs to be connected through Google Analytics. Regional Google searches suggest possible subjects; they do not yet tell us what Rick's readers enjoy.

Future sequence: save dated research → choose a relevant angle → draft a short caption → generate locally from the approved scene → inspect → prepare for publication.

WHERE WE ARE GOING

Where we go from here.

The immediate priority is a convincing room and dependable characters. Once those are right, more time can go into the observation and the joke.

Ready to review

The redesigned studio, organized image library, shared notes and revised newspaper layout.

Still being refined

The room's proportions, the window corner, the bar, the light and the quality of the pen strokes.

Coming next

Separate shelves and fixtures, the New York street view, and more consistent character appearances.

THE NEXT FOUR STEPS

01 Finish the room

Make the wall, window and counter feel physically believable. Settle the light and the viewing angle before adding anything else.

02 Add the pieces

Perfect each liquor shelf, then the TV, chalkboard, street scene and small details. Keep every piece easy to adjust.

03 Settle the cast

Refine Barclay's head and ear, keep Drew consistent, and bring Abby in only with an appearance that works.

04 Develop the daily rhythm

Choose relevant Naples financial stories, write a strong caption, make the drawing and review it carefully before preparing it for publication.

The standard: a reader should notice the characters and the joke. The room, lighting and drawing should feel natural enough to support them quietly.

THE DRAWING BOARD

Thirteen room studies.

These studies explore the room, woodwork, light and shade. Some are earlier experiments; the last two show the newer outline and lighting plan. All are work in progress.



Bare room A



Bare room B



Bare room C



Layout study A



Layout study B



Woodwork A



Woodwork B



Finish study A



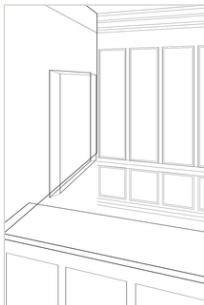
Finish study B



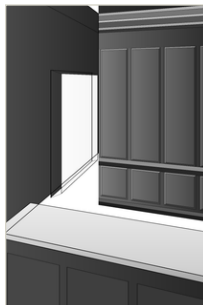
Lighting study A



Lighting study B



Newer room outline



Newer lighting plan

EXPLORE THE WORK

[Current studio preview](#)

[Google Trends: Ft. Myers-Naples research](#) | [Collier property-value guide](#)

The studio preview uses the existing sign-in. This report brings together the September 3 work; the drawings will continue to evolve as details are refined.